

**A Comparative Study on
the Parent-Child Relationship of Baby Boomers,
Generation X, Generation Y
& Generation Z**

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Abstract

Differences in suppositions among parents and children, regardless of whether it is with respect to something trivial, are a typical issue in every household, but is it a matter of concern for every generation? Thus, the research has been conducted to analyze the parenting strategy of parents from different generations along with the impacts of those parenting ideologies upon children from the economically influential Baby Boomers generation to Generation Z. The prime emphasis has been put upon the bonding of parents with their children and vice versa through various scenarios from regular life and lifestyle, including how frequently they spend quality time to how often they are bound by some general limitations. Alongside these, the focus has been made upon the generations they belong to. For this, we worked with four generations, namely, Baby Boomers, Generation X, Generation Y, and Generation Z. Thus, to guide us through our research, an online survey had been opted for people from age 8 and above to recognize the sentiments from individuals belonging to different generations. Upon analysis, we came to the conclusion that it is basically not the generation to be at blame for the strength of the bonding. Rather, it is the ideology of parents belonging to the forbearing generation to impose their children to a stricter one and vice versa.

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1. Introduction

Parents are consistently occupied with something and it is typical on the grounds that adulthood brings tons of obligations along. Most parents invest a large portion of their time and energy at work, while others invest that vast majority on themselves or on their family only. Here, by family, we mean grandparents, new-born babies, etc. Children, on the other hand, spend most of their time at school, with teachers and classmates. More grown-up children spend most of their time with their friends, books, games, gadgets, social media, etc. Yet, the parental role remains an essential part, because parents prepare children for their future, but this nurturing ideology varies from generation to generation. Irrespective of all these, the majority is unaware of the ideal solution. For instance, parents of Baby Boomers mostly had the propensity of feeding their children and making girls eligible for marriage and boys capable of earning a living. In that era, a child's mentality and psychological upbringing was not a matter of concern. However, this ideology changed a lot. Parents belonging to Baby Boomers' generation to Generation Y believe in proper upbringing to make their child a better representative amidst this competitive society. Along with this, to ensure the safety of their child amidst this brutal and narcissistic society, parents tend to be a little too harsh which children cannot take easily. These issues might look minor but these mostly impact the parent-child relationship. Now, keeping the strict environment they had, parents of Generation Z try to be more lenient and tolerant but is that justified or it is putting forward a care-free generation that is not generally worthy. Studies on comparisons of different generations have been conducted already, however, this current paper features the association of common individuals of a Bengali household, where at most three generations live under the same roof.

It was hypothesized that with the advancement of time, parent-child relationships are losing the strength of bonding in between, for parents are being more authoritative and children are being nonchalant about the rules and ideal norms. Parents belonging to the Baby Boomers generation and Generation Y were expected to be more lenient along with having an inadequate profound association with their child than those belonging to Generation X.

Upon additional investigation, it was evident that the offspring of each generation had tremendous regard and love towards their parents independent of the changing pattern in severity, strictness, and closeness. Thus, in the final hypothesis, it is very well inferred that the ages that were raised in a strict environment gave an indulgent and lenient atmosphere to their procreations and vice-versa. Subsequently edifying the way that despite the fact that Baby Boomers were lenient with their children, this leniency downgraded in further generations with severity and strictness. However, the bonding and association between parents and children are raising throughout the succession of time.

2. Literature Review

This study aims to examine certain factors which affect, or has affected, the parent-child relationship throughout successive generations. Our research mainly focuses on four generations respectively: The Baby Boomers, Generation X, Generation Y, and Generation Z. Throughout the paper we would be using these four terms quite casually and thus, the introduction of their terminology.

Baby Boomers are people that fall under the age group of 56-74 years. The name was posed after World War II when the “Americans were enjoying new-found prosperity, which resulted in a ‘baby boom’ ” (“Boomers, Gen X, Gen Y, and Gen Z Explained,” 2020). The following generation, however, was named after the alphabet ‘X’. Generation X, or Gen X, consists of the people that were born between the years 1965 and 1980 inclusive. In other words, they are the people that are currently 40-55 years old. Apparently, the next two generations also took on alphabets as their mouthpiece. Generation Y, or millennials, are said to be the ones born between the years 1981 to 1996 with ages 24 to 39. We will be using the term ‘Generation Y’ or ‘Gen Y’ throughout our research paper for simplicity. And finally, we have Generation Z, or Gen Z, who are the ones belonging to the age group of 8 to 23 years old.

When studying the relationship of parents with their children, several issues such as the usage of technology, communication, etc. come into consideration. But such factors often vary from generation to generation. Back in the days of Baby Boomers, there was either very little or no technological influence at all. They would pursue, what one should call, the basic, yet a somewhat rebellious lifestyle. Being born after World War II, boomers relentlessly possessed a sense of liberty and social rebellion along with a fair amount of respect for their parents. To quote an author’s views, “they may love their parents, but when it comes time to

talk about politics, marriage, drugs, or sex, the Baby Boomers respectfully disagree” (Light as cited in Bee, 2017, p. 12). Boomers are said to be the ‘lifelong learners’ and often consider the younger generation to be ‘rude’ or disrespectful (Du, 2011, p. 11). This ideology in turn affected their children, as in Generation X. Since the Baby Boomers grew up having a carefree and distinguished mindset, they passed on their ideals and experiences to their children. They were considerably concerned about providing proper financial support to the family which often bound them to work late. Researches show that their children were one of the first to experience daycare or return to an empty house (Bee, 2017, p. 13). Thus, there was considerably a huge gap in the level of communication between the two groups. The Baby Boomers were not as strict as their succeeding generation, allowing the concept of free will to prevail. However, the framework of parenting took quite the opposite road when led by Generation X. In terms of job and employment, they were/ are excessively active. A fair percentage of people belonging to this generation group are willingly seen to undertake the responsibility of their parents. Gorman (2017) discusses how Generation X is struggling to stand by their Boomer parents, who readily suffer from physical ailments. They have an obligation to maintain their children as well as their feeble parents. Gen X is also known to be technologically active, but not too enthusiastic about it. Despite being relatively job oriented, Gen X would try to provide quality time to their children. As opposed to their parents, “they tend to be indifferent about advancement and care more about creating a work-life balance” (Veloz, 2010, p. 35). Most would take part in the academic ‘parent-teacher-meetings’ to remind children about their role in their lives and how they are not being ignored. However, they would also impose curfews and other relevant forms of restrictions on their children in the name of fair parenting.

Generation Y is known to be more socially skilled compared to Gen X or even Gen Z. When talking about Gen Y, we ought to look around and contemplate the behavior of senior

students and the aspiring working class in our society. Gen Y has a strong will, and is thoroughly motivated to introduce good changes into society. They are determined to change the world for good and believe that, “preceding generations have made huge mistakes, resulting in problems in the world” (Veloz, 2010, p. 37). They were either brought up by the late Baby Boomers or Generation X parents, who were either fully flexible or undoubtedly overprotective. As mentioned in Bee’s (2017) paper, Generation Y is said to be an excellent user of technology and great multitaskers. From a general perspective, “they view technology as ethereal and tangible” (Veloz, 2010, p. 38). They are well educated and are concerned about their future from a relatively earlier age. As parents, Gen Y seeks to “correct the wrongs of their parents by becoming better, more ideal parents” (Veloz, 2010, p. 39). Unlike Gen X, Gen Y parents tend to teach their children to “give” or “do” for others. This includes shaping their children to be nonjudgmental and welcoming of diversity.

Our final generation group incorporates Generation Z, which unfortunately has very few promising resources to refer to. The chief personas of this group include children, young adults, and mostly teenagers. This generation is profusely influenced by technology and “is accustomed to the rapid diffusion of information presented in a graphically and technologically sophisticated style” (“Generations X, Y, and Z,” 2019). Some experts have argued that over-usage or over-exposure to technology has shortened their attention spans. Therefore, parents who are unable to keep up with this pace of advancement often lack a healthy bonding with their children of this very generation. Nonetheless, there are also studies that claim, “42% of Gen Z children will follow their parents’ example as compared to 36% of Gen Y children” (Valdeavilla as cited in Swanzen, 2018, p. 134). That is, the ones being raised by parents who tend to be more practical, share a fair pact of bonding with their parents.

All the corresponding theses, journals, and articles have discussed the behaviors, lifestyles, and relationships of parents with their children from different generations. They have defined and interpreted their hypothesis based on certain studies and data collection. Our research also inaugurates by familiarizing the audience with the respective generations. But what makes it unique and atypical is the involvement of all four generations: Boomers, Gen X, Gen Y, and Gen Z. So far, no researcher has talked about all four generations in one paper. Furthermore, our research is constricted only to the locality of Bangladesh, making it compact yet perceptible.

3. Methodology

The objective of the research was to try finding out what turns did the parent-child relationship take over generations. To achieve this, we had to collect data on what people think about their bonding with their parents and to what extent it matches to how much parents think they understand their children. Woefully, our data collection was very constricted due to the current pandemic situation. We were not in the state to conduct sufficient in-person interviews so the whole survey was conducted through an online form. Keeping in mind the huge range of age our research demands to be covered, we distributed the form through social media to friends, teachers, and family. It was not feasible to reach people of all age classes via social media. However, respecting the proper collection of data, many fellow mates interviewed parents and even grandparents and responded to the survey accordingly, on their behalf. Heartfelt regards from the team to all of them, for being so kind and doing what we were actually meant to.

As obvious as it should have been, it was more a piece of cake to get 50 responses from Generation Z and equally hard even to achieve half the amount of responses from the Baby Boomers; accessibility, availability, and willing assistance all became crucial factors. In the end, we managed to toll a total amount of 171 responses, 44.4% of which belonged to Generation Z, 76 responses from the youngsters. Amongst the rest, we had 34 responses from Generation Y, which made up around 20% of the sample, 30 responses from Generation X, 17.5% and 21, being only 12.3% out of the total, from Baby Boomers. The final 10 responses came from people above 75 years, the last 5.8% to complete the account. Clearly, the responses of the older classes were harder to manage. We had to hold people on calls, request others to interview an elderly person, and whatnot!

A large number of possible respondents were not accessible through social media, especially Baby Boomers and their parents, this eventually lowered the total number of

responses. Moreover, people aged more than 75 are rare. Besides this, proper access to the internet and social media as well as having someone to record the answers made it even harder. Thus, the responses from the Baby Boomers class were least, whereas those from Generation Z were easiest to manage; which made our findings to have quite a limited amount of aged minds contributing. It was pretty much a mind game to prepare questions fulfilling the demand of the targeted aspect and the spreadsheets required ace technical hands to process data. In the end, everything was only possible because of the patience and active cooperation of everyone, from youngsters and grandparents. Heartfelt thanks to everyone contributing to make this research see the daylight.

4. Findings

4.1 Baby Boomers:

The population born between 1946 and 1964 are categorized as the Baby Boomers. People belonging to this generation are between 56-74 years old at present. We were able to collect 21 responses for the Baby Boomer generation, amongst them 10 were male and 11 were female. Hence, all the percentages will be in regard to our sample size of 21.

Baby Boomers as children:

According to our findings, most Baby Boomers experienced strict parenting during their childhood. In cases of going out or hanging out with friends, around 66.7 percent were unable to get permission from their parents. Around 85.7 percent encountered strict rules regarding staying out late, staying over at others', dressing style, etc., and almost all the participants said they had to take permission before going somewhere. While it came to fulfilling demands, we found that most of their parents would first reason their wants before fulfilling them, and in some cases, only the necessities were met. Due to this strictness, it is found that around two-thirds of the participants had to make fake excuses or lie to their parents and some did it very often.

Despite having strict parents, we see that some of the Baby Boomers also experienced a close relationship with their parents, especially with their mothers. As per the responses, when asked who would they choose to spend a day with (given that there was no Internet), around 23.8 percent said they would choose their mother. When asked to choose one person to take on a luxurious experience, while 95.2 percent said they would take a family member, amongst them around 23.8 percent chose their mother. Also, around two-thirds responded that they would go to their parents for advice while making crucial decisions. Although we witness Baby Boomers to be close to their parents in most cases, it can be seen that their

parents were not as involved in their lives in certain aspects. For example, in case a child ended up in a fight, only around 9.53 percent of the parents would have a proper discussion with them regarding the matter while the others would either punish them or just let them handle things on their own. Moreover, in the majority of cases, the parents of Baby Boomers did not have much influence on their career choices. Also, taking into account the perspective of the Baby Boomer's parents, we see that around 70 percent of parents are not always aware of everything regarding their children's lives.

Baby Boomers as parents:

In terms of parenting, Baby Boomers seem to present some similar parenting patterns as their parents with a few adaptations. In terms of strictness, around 69 percent of parents from this generation would impose strict rules such as curfews (no staying out late) and no sleepovers at friends. In case of fulfilling their children's demands, around two-thirds would meet their children's requests only if it deemed reasonable. In spite of the strict rules and regulations, compared to their parents, Baby Boomers are found to be more invested in trying to keep up with their children's generation. Around 57.1 percent are connected with their children on social media. Also, when it comes to handling misbehaviors like lying and fighting, this parent generation is more likely to use a more understanding and rational approach compared to their own parents such as having a discussion. Hence, around 61.9 percent of parents think that their child is very likely to come to them for advice in case of problems. Moreover, when asked to choose one person to take on a luxurious experience, about one-third said they would choose one of their children. Despite the more lenient parenting compared to their parents, Baby Boomer stated that around 76.2 percent of them are not always aware of everything going on in their children's life. Thus, there must be some sort of a gap in communication or understanding, which shall be discussed in the latter part.

4.2 Generation X:

The population born between 1965 and 1979/80 are categorized as Generation X. People belonging to this generation are between 40-55 years old at present. We were able to collect 30 responses for Generation X, amongst them 9 were male and 21 were female. Hence, all the percentages will be in regard to our sample size of 30.

Generation X as children:

Over 56 percent of the parents of Generation X are found to belong to the Baby Boomers generation, and hence they experienced a mixture of strict parenting with some liberal approaches. In cases of going out or hanging out with friends, around 56.7 percent were unable to get permission from their parents. The majority encountered strict rules regarding staying out late, staying over at others', dressing style, etc., and almost all the participants said they had to take permission before going somewhere. Despite some of the strict rules, when it came to fulfilling demands, we found that 40 percent would say yes instantly and around 16.7 percent would agree if the demands were within reason.

We also found that Generation X's parents were more involved in their lives, and they also experienced a more close relationship with their parents, especially with their mothers. As per the responses, when asked who would they choose to spend a day with (given that there was no Internet), around 43.3 percent said they would choose their mother. When asked to choose one person to take on a luxurious experience, while 96.7 percent said they would take a family member, amongst them about one third chose their mother. In case of misbehaviors such as getting into a fight, around 63.3 percent of the parents would have a proper discussion with the children regarding the matter. Moreover, around 40 percent of participants said that their parents had a major influence on their career choices. From such close relationships, develops transparency; and we found that around 40 percent of the

Generation X children never felt the need to lie to their parents while 50 percent only made up fake excuses on rare occasions. Furthermore, when it came to making crucial life decisions, around 73.3 percent stated that they would go to their parents to seek advice. Also, the majority of the participants expressed the desire to live with their parents and support them in their old age.

Generation X as parents:

In terms of parenting, Generation X seem to present some similar parenting patterns as their parents with some more leniency. In terms of strictness, around 50 percent of parents from this generation would impose strict rules such as curfews (no staying out late) and a majority would not allow sleepovers at friends. In case of fulfilling their children's demands, around 73.3 percent would meet their children's requests within their capacity. Generation X is also found to be very invested in trying to keep up with their children's generation. Around 46.7 percent are connected with their children on social media. Also, when it comes to handling misbehaviors, this parent generation is more likely to use a liberal and understanding approach. For example, in case catching their child lying, around 90 percent of the parents would have a proper discussion with them regarding the matter. Hence, about two-thirds of the parents think that their children are very likely to come to them for advice in case of problems. Despite the lenient parenting and closeness, Generation X stated that around 50 percent of them are not always aware of everything going on in their children's life.

4.3 Generation Y:

The population born between 1981 and 1996 are categorized as Generation Y. People belonging to this generation are between 24-39 years old at present. We were able to collect

34 responses for Generation Y, amongst them 15 were male and 19 were female. Hence, all the percentages will be in regard to our sample size of 34.

Generation Y as children:

Around 82.3 percent of the parents of Generation Y are found to belong to the Baby Boomers generation while the rest belong to Generation X, and hence they experienced a mixture of strict parenting with some liberal approaches. In cases of going out or hanging out with friends, around 32.4 percent were unable to get permission from their parents. Around 85.3 percent of the children encountered strict rules regarding staying out late, staying over at others', dressing style, etc. and around 70.5 percent of the participants said they had to take permission before going somewhere. Despite some of the strict rules, when it came to fulfilling demands, we found that 47.1 percent would say yes mostly while the rest would agree if the demands were within reason.

Much like Generation X, we found that Generation Y's parents were also very involved in their life, and they experienced a very close relationship with their parents, especially their mothers. As per the responses, when asked who they would choose to spend a day with (given that there was no Internet), around 50 percent said they would choose their mother. When asked to choose one person to take on a luxurious experience, while 70.6 percent said they would take a family member, amongst them around 26.5 percent chose their mothers. When it comes to handling misbehaviors like lying and fighting, this parent generation is more likely to use a more understanding and rational approach. Moreover, around 44.1 percent of participants said that their parents had a major influence on their career choices. When it came to making crucial life decisions, around 76.5 percent stated that they would go to their parents to seek advice. Also, the majority of the participants expressed the desire to live with their parents and support them in their old age. In spite of having such

a close relationship, we found that around 35.3 percent of the Generation Y children had to make fake excuses for their parents very often and around 38.2 percent sometimes, which indicates a lack of communication and understanding.

Generation Y as parents:

In terms of parenting, Generation Y has a very lenient approach compared to the previous generations. Rules and regulations such as curfews (no staying out late) do not seem to be a widespread practice, and they sometimes even allow sleepovers at friends. In the case of fulfilling their children's demands, a large majority would meet their children's requests within their capacity. Generation Y is also found to always try to keep up with their children's generation and maintain transparency in their relationship. Also, when it comes to handling misbehaviors, this parent generation is more likely to use a liberal and understanding approach such as having a talk with them about the matter. Hence, most of the parents think that their children are very likely to turn to them in need of advice during important decision-making, and they try to stay much updated about everything going on in their children's lives.

4.4 Generation Z:

The population born between 1997 and 2012/15 are categorized as Generation Z. People belonging to this generation are between 8-23 years old at present. We were able to collect 79 responses for Generation Z, amongst them 36 were male and 40 were female. Hence, all the percentages will be in regard to our sample size of 79.

Generation Z as children:

Around 65.8 percent of the parents of Generation Z are found to belong to the Baby Boomers generation while 32.9 percent belong to Generation X and only around 1.3 percent

belong to Millennials, and hence they are found to experience a mixture of diverse parenting patterns during their childhood. In cases of going out or hanging out with friends, around 48.3 percent were unable to get permission from their parents, which is a little higher compared to the previous generations. The majority of the children encountered strict rules regarding no Wi-Fi after midnight, handing of cell phones, staying out late, staying over at others', dressing style, etc. and around 91.1 percent of the participants said they had to take permission before going somewhere. Despite some of the strict rules, when it came to fulfilling demands, we found that the vast majority would say yes mostly while the rest would agree if the demands were within reason and their capacity. In terms of handling misbehaviors like getting into a fight, around 54.4 percent of the parents would have a discussion regarding the matter.

According to the survey, we can see that Generation Z's parents are very involved in their life. While they experience a very close relationship with their parents, there still seems to be a gap in communication. Around 35.4 percent of the participants are not connected to their parents on social media, and around 15.2 percent said that their parents have restricted access to their social media, e.g. cannot see their posts. As per the responses, when asked who they would choose to spend a day with (given that there was no Internet), around 38 percent would choose to be by themselves and around 25.3 percent would spend time with friends. In spite of a communication gap, around 27.8 percent said they would never lie to their parents while 45.6 percent said they would make fake excuses on rare occasions when necessary. Also, when asked to choose one person to take on a luxurious experience, the majority said they would choose a family member. Around 33 percent of participants said that their parents had a major influence on their career choices. Moreover, when it came to making crucial life decisions, around 80 percent stated that they would go to their parents to

seek advice. And finally, the vast majority hopes to stay by their parents' side in their old age and support them.

Generation Z as parents:

No findings have been found regarding Generation Z's role as a parent since this generation is still relatively very young

5. Discussions

With data collected from the survey and the graph laid below, it can be concluded that the majority of the parents from the Baby-Boomers' generation and Gen X have their first child from Gen Y and Gen Z, respectively.

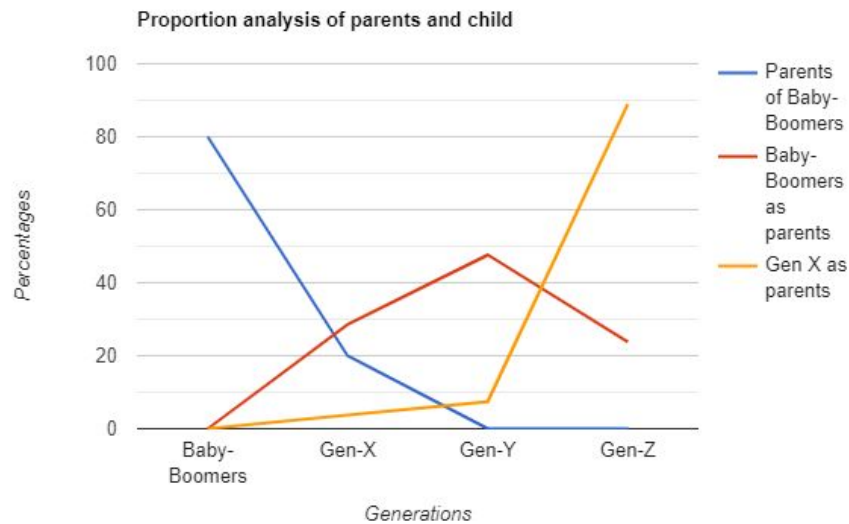


Figure: 5.1

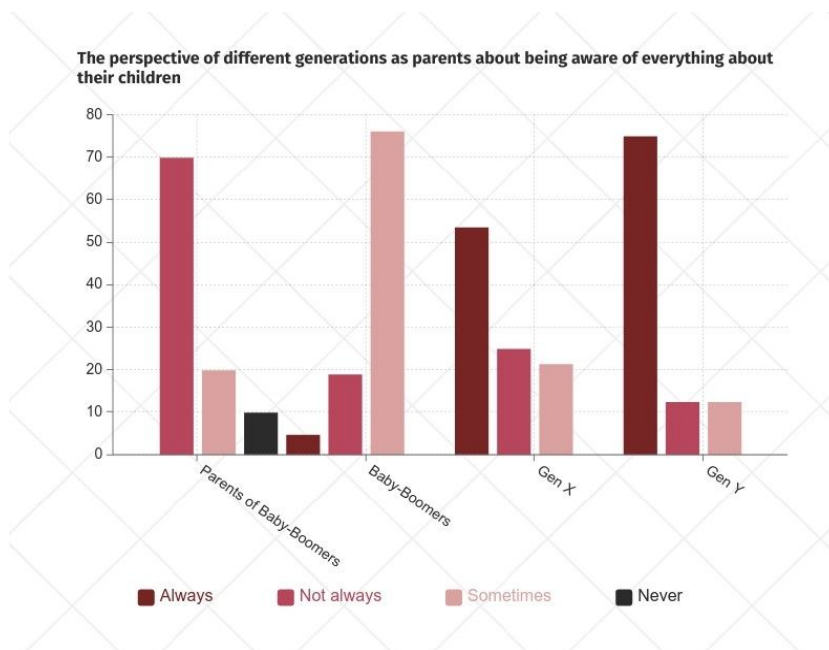


Figure: 5.2

As indicated by figure 5.2, parents of Baby-Boomers seem to be a neglecting generation because no generations were found to be

completely unconscious of the mishaps that occur as they opted for “never” which no other generations did. However, it may be a misconception of the parents because when surveyed

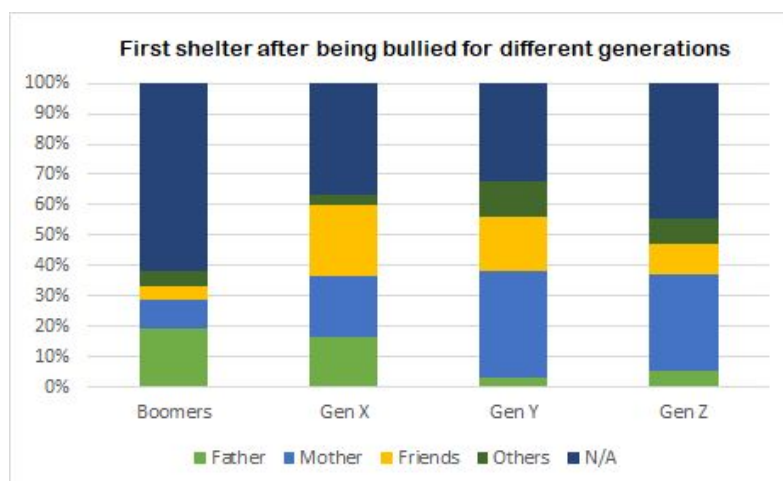


Figure: 5.3

with the children, a minimal proportion of the children from the Baby-Boomers generation opted to approach their parents, especially their fathers, in severe situations, thus showing a compassionate

bonding between parent and child.

Now if we focus on these children during their parenthood, we see them being on the average line of certainty. However, as they claim that they are “sometimes” mindful of all that happens in the lives of their children, we can clearly see the priority list of children belonging to Gen Y, who prefer to reach their mothers for issues like bullying, instead of going elsewhere. Hence, knowingly or unknowingly their relations are strengthened with trust and assistance. To accentuate further, when we look upon Gen X as parents, we see that they are quite a bit confident about knowing a great deal about their peer’s life, even though they preferred reaching their friends in situations like bullying, which can take any course anytime. However, their bonding with their children can be judged with optimism as a greater proportion of individuals of Gen Z chose their mother above all other options. The most confident generation of parents seems to be Gen Y, subsequently wishing them luck on successful parenting. Thus, to conclude, we can say that both parents are equally essential for the upbringing of a child, but a child is closer to its mother, thus showing us a greater significance of the importance and impact of mother upon a child and its upbringing. We can

also conclude that with every passing generation, children are getting closer to their parents in terms of conveying their emotions which is an incredible deal and improvement.

Presently, to compare the propensity of faking excuses which have always been the masterplan to get things done as per plan, we can clearly see that almost all individuals belonging to different generations had to use up their trump card of excuses. However, a conflict is seen between Gen Y and Gen Z with that of Gen X, as the majority of Gen X voted that they never had the need to fake up excuses

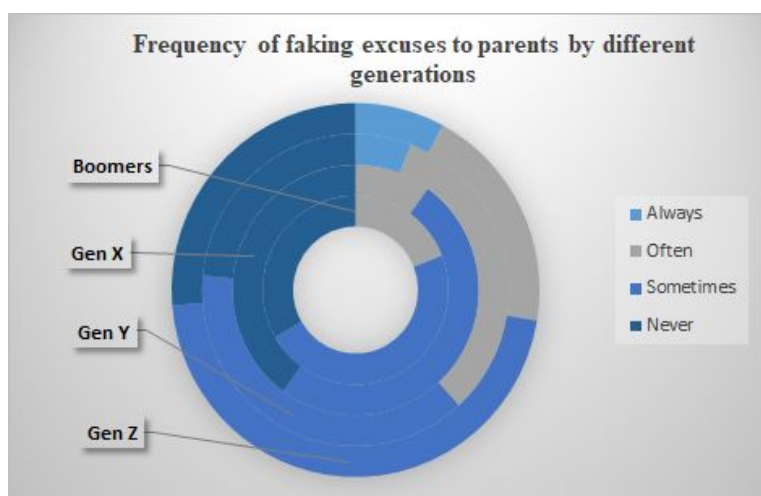


Figure: 5.4

whereas Gen Y and Gen Z concluded as a necessity. Now, if we trace back a bit, we can see that Gen X stepped into parenting as they entered Gen Z. So, we can easily see that Gen X is following the trend of strict parenting which actuated their children to seek the aid of excuses, which they themselves as children did not opt for.

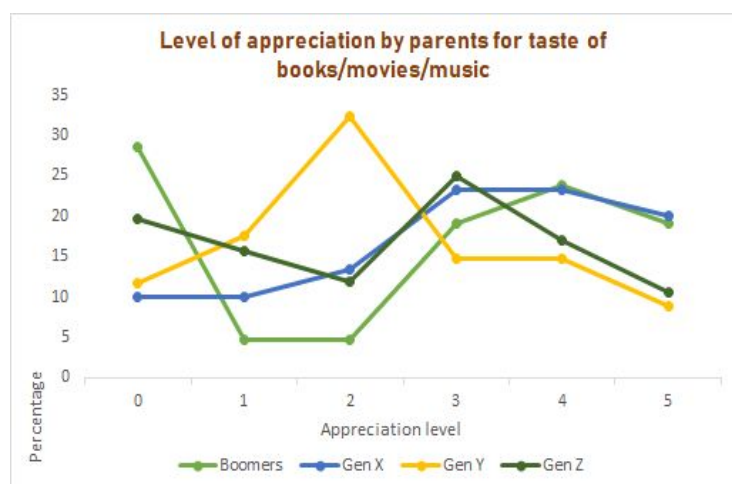


Figure: 5.5

Figure: 5.5 shows us the level of appreciation children of different generations received from their parents, considering 0 to be 'never' and 5 to be 'always'. For Gen Z, a good amount of, around 20%, children do not have

similar tastes in either books, music, or movies which their parents might like whereas, the other side of the picture says, a similar amount of parents sync in. Gen X seems to share the closest fondness with parents, a higher number of them got positively welcomed by parents. Baby Boomers had the most varying taste to that of their parents, almost 30% demanded never to be appreciated about personal taste, on the other hand, a handful was regularly valued. Gen Y shared similar taste to parents ‘sometimes’, which, however, occurred very frequently.

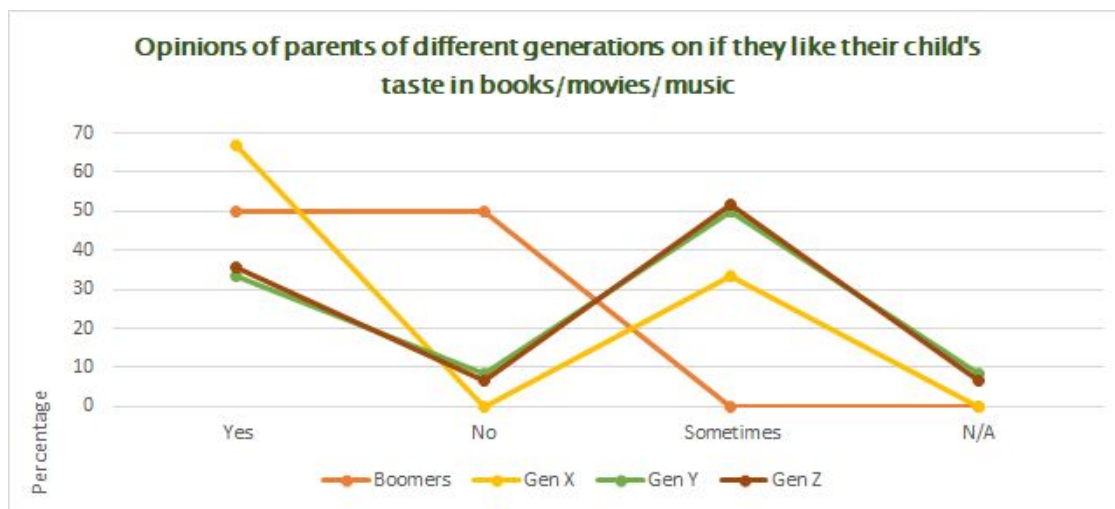


Figure: 5.6

When parents of the discussed generations placed their opinion on children's taste, those of Boomers clearly tied between their children having the likable taste or not. Parents of Gen X voted never to have a dissimilar taste to that of their child and parents of Gen Y preferred saying their mentality matched ‘sometimes’. All these match well to the children's opinion. The conflict comes as the parents of Gen Z demand to appreciate their children's taste ‘more’ but the children think that to come in lower levels.

We can conclude that with time, generations tend to have more similarities as well as increasing dissimilarity in taste with their parents. It might turn out that their choice of books sync but at the same time music does not, but our research does not specify that.

Another possible conclusion can be such that the parent-child understanding has degraded over generations, a larger number of Gen Z parents try to cooperate with their children but the kids seem to be unaware of that.

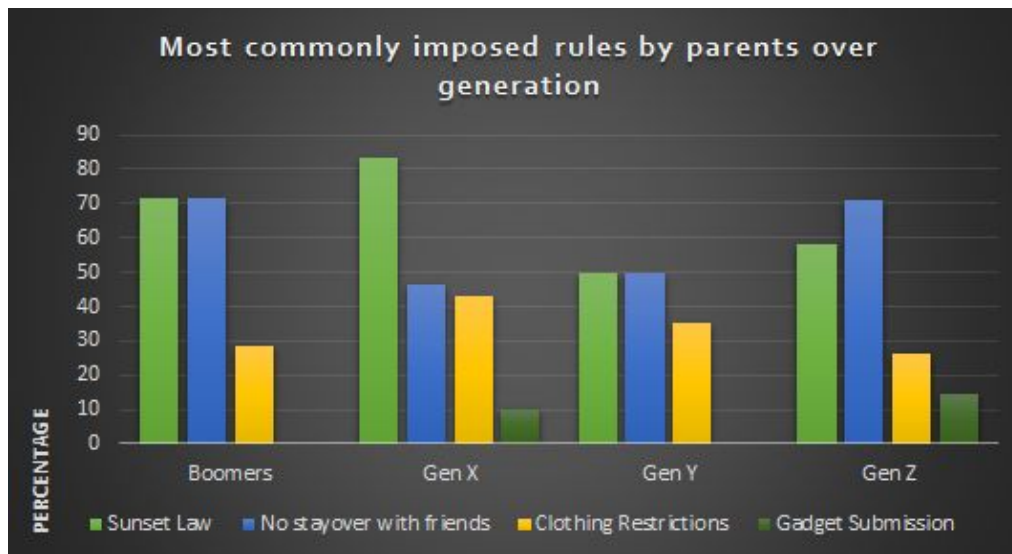


Figure: 5.7

The parental rule is an evergreen aspect that children of every generation had to face. The application of some of these rules is heavily influenced by society and some, in recent times, varies with the promising availability of technology. Like, earlier parents never required to think of how long their child should stay in front of the screen or stay immersed in their cell phones. However, implications of certain rules pass down as “inherited properties” which, in special cases, might just have their importance reduced but never to be erased from the general parent-child terms.

Among the set of several laws and orders provided in the form, three were voted famous by children of all four classes. But few significant differences popped out among all the similarities. ‘No stayover with friends’ has been a well-practiced rule for years. More than 70% of Boomers were under it. Although the implication fell noticeably for Gen X and Gen Y, 45% and 50% respectively, the authority of this shot up to over 70% again for Gen Z. The fierce, insecure society ought to play a major role behind parents being protective. Besides

this, to work out how much one's own life gets reflected in his/her parenting, we asked parents whether they are willing to let their children stay over at friends'. Here we noticed, the more 'no' the parents in their childhood heard, the higher the chances their children get the red signal. However, some strictly regulated children turned out to be

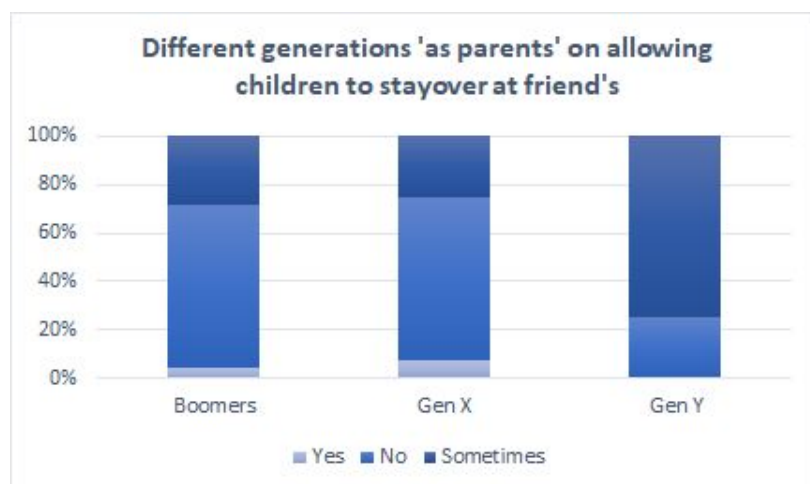


Figure: 5.7

preferred more on deciding upon the situation.

kind-hearted parents. The trend looks alike for Boomers and Gen X as parents. Although Gen Y was less under this law, this class of young parents is uncertain if they should let their child stay out and

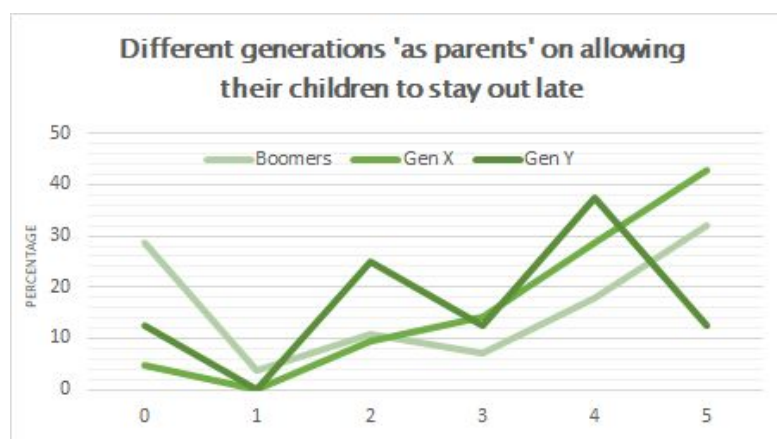


Figure: 5.9

(Fig: 5.9). Gen X was apparently allowed to stayover outside at night but had to return home early if they wished to. This had a heavy impact on their parenting as parents of this generation are strict about returning home earlier. For Gen Y, rules applied had rather a contradicting effect on their parenting; as parents, they prefer children to return earlier.

Another commonly applied rule is returning home early. The Boomers were similarly strictly under this rule, as the previous one, which made them both stick strictly to this rule and relax it as parents

However, since the Gen Zs are least allowed to stay out overnight, they got the access to return home late, a bit more than earlier generations.

Restrictions upon clothing have fallen uniformly over generations since Gen X. For Baby Boomers, high chances that styling was not much of a concern then.

From all these, we can conclude that over time, parents are becoming less conservative and more secure.

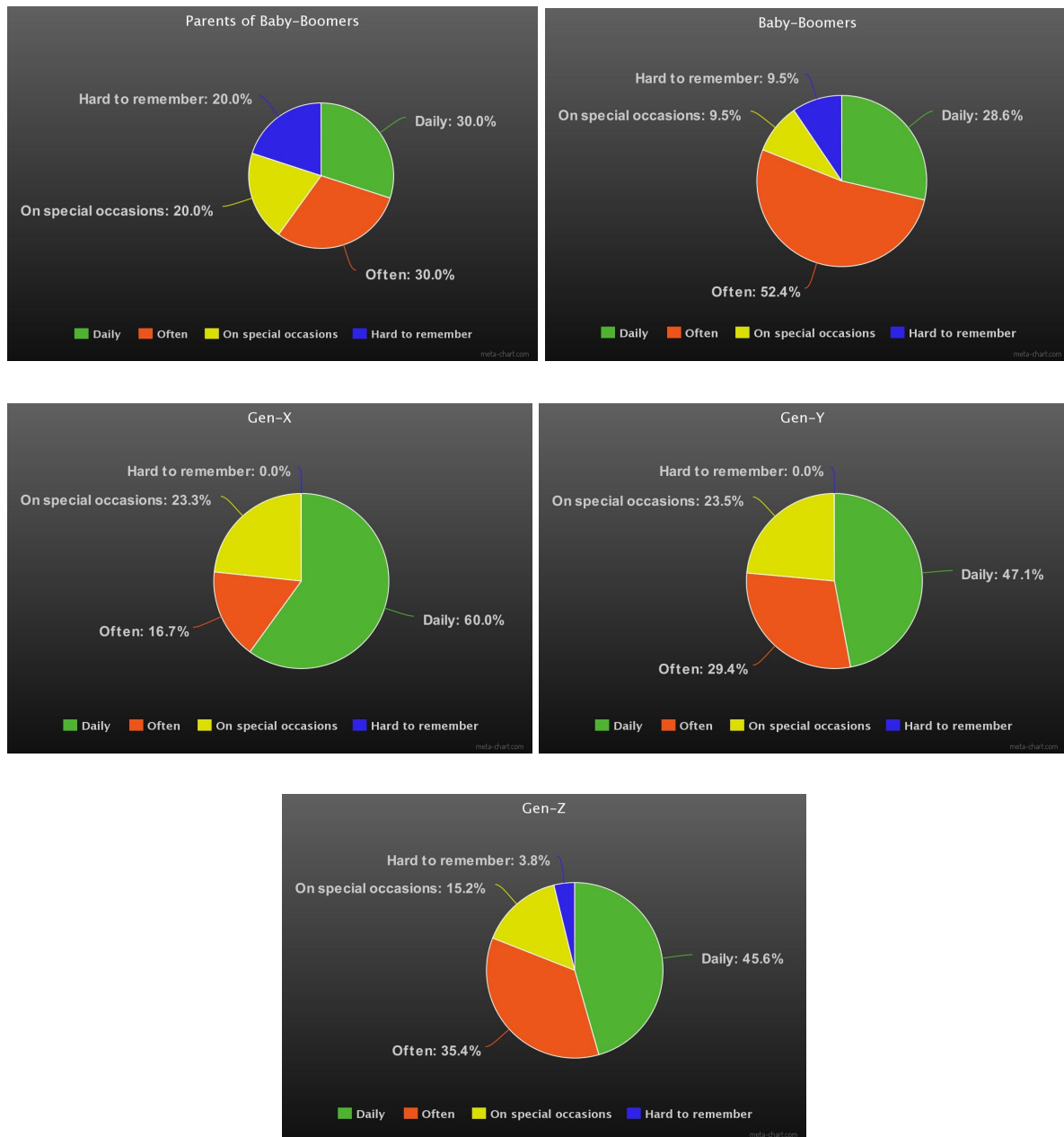
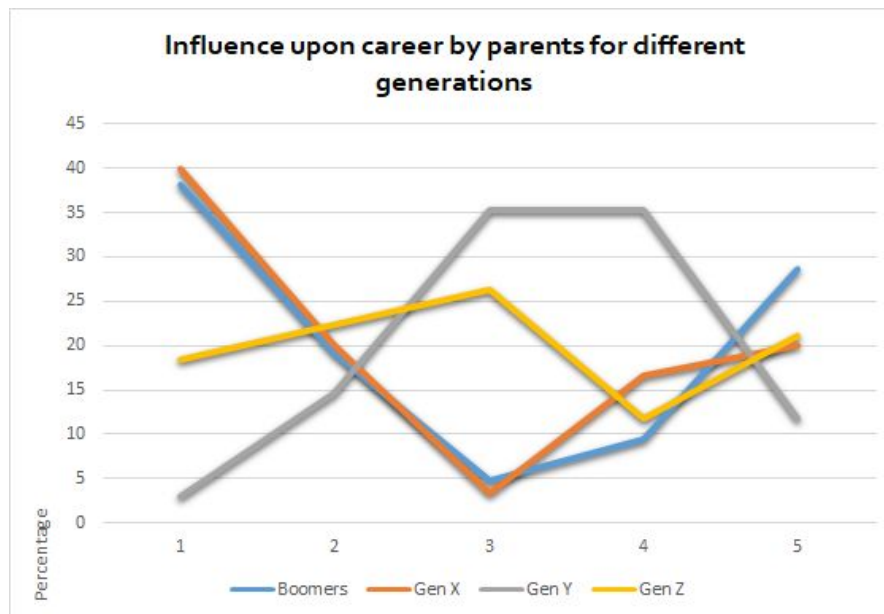


Figure:5.10 (Frequency of having meal together)

We all have our frenzied timetables laid previously and this is something ordinary. However, finding a couple of seconds with family, abandoning all pressure and the remaining burden is a fundamental part too. Most importantly, the pattern of the recurrence of having meals together, where each individual from the family partakes in, seems to be insignificant for generations prior to Gen X where the trend changed dramatically. The accompanying generations, in particular, Y and Z additionally show an expanding pattern, dissimilar to those of the Baby-Boomers generation. To concentrate further, it is somewhat evident for Baby-Boomers and parents of Baby-Boomers to select "hard to recollect" in light of the fact that, for them, those occasions occurred a long time back. Consequently, to conclude, it can be said that the increasing propensity of hobnobbing and the idea of fellowship is obviously apparent as we progress through generations.



When it comes to deciding what one gets to become in his/her life, parents still tend to play an influential role in it in our society. Dreams of becoming the parents of a

Figure:5.11

profession strangle million unspoken desires. When asked children of all four generations, Baby Boomers seemed to have extremes in both most pressurized by parents and least. One of the reasons might be that families back then used to be massive and the initial breadwinners had heavy parental influence to select career paths whereas, children afterward

were not cared much about. A similar trend is followed by Gen X. Gen Y, on the other hand, also has extremes but in a negative way, very few parents did not influence at all or influenced a lot. Most of them were 'moderately' influenced by parents. Scenarios changed for Gen Z, as a similar amount of children were divided among being influenced, not influenced, and heavily influenced.

From these, we can conclude that the parent-child relationship used to be inconsistent in terms of the child's future. Over time, parents tend to become more concerned about their children's future and try to stay involved as they make their life's decisions. At last, the latest generation, having parents, too, studied and qualified, has a comparatively higher parental influence upon the career. Also, a handful is blessed with open-minded parents to not impose dreams at all.

6. Conclusion

Throughout the years, parenting in Bangladesh has taken up several twists and turns. The attitude or behavior of different generations towards their parents or children are a key factor to take into account in order to study the pattern of the relationship between successive generations. Our research has helped provide a brief about the parent-child relationship in our country which, surprisingly, hasn't quite delivered the smoothest of results. As per the results of our research survey, Baby Boomers were reported to have a rather ambiguous link with their parents. Most of their parents seemed to be quite unaware of the incidents going on in their children's lives. Surprisingly, Boomers did not quite feel the same way. Most of them expressed their fondness and endearment to their parents undeniably. This mismatch of ideas led us to draw a conclusion of an inconsistent relationship between the two groups. Possible reasons include lack of communication or understanding due to a relatively larger family or the factor of career influence. On the other hand, Gen X was seen to have an exemplary bonding with their children of Gen Z. Despite revealing a somewhat strict attitude towards their children, Gen X would always have their children looking up to them for advice. Gen Z often felt the need to make up fake excuses under certain circumstances, but would indeed always feel the need to prioritize their parents' wellbeing at the end. The parental method of Gen X can thus be referred to as ideal. Moving on to Gen Y, they often had a similar opinion and taste as with that of their parents, the Boomers. Being brought up in a somewhat versatile manner, Gen Y decided to move with a stricter ideology with their children. Many of our data pointed out how they would decline their child's request of staying outdoors late. However, they reportedly seemed to be the most confident generation in terms of parenting.

In conclusion, the generations consisting of relatively strict parents grew up to be lenient or more ideal parents and those with the lax parents turned out to be authoritarians.

Our findings prove Baby Boomers to be liberal parents. On the contrary, Gen Y as parents are deemed to sit far behind in this regard, since parents become more authoritative and children become nonchalant about the rules and ideal norms. Therefore, it cannot be deduced whether parent-child relationships are losing strength with the advancement of time as there are no fixed patterns with changing generations.

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